Gradi Puata

+27-68-048-8872 | gradipuata@gmail.com | gradi-puata | codewithgradi

Education

Richfield Graduate Institute of Technology — Durban, South Africa
Bachelor of Science in Information Technology — *Jan. 2025 – Present*
- Top Achiever Semester 1 and 2 of Year 1 – 2025.

Northwood School — Durban North, South Africa
National Senior Certificate — *Jan. 2021 – Dec. 2022*

Experience

Basketball Coach — Jan. 2025 – Present
Eden Schools — *Durban, KwaZulu-Natal*
- Led and mentored a team of 12 athletes, designing data-driven training programs to improve individual performance and overall team strategy.
- Managed high-pressure situations and conflict resolution during competitive matches, demonstrating strong leadership and maintaining team cohesion under stress.

Web Developer — Jul. 2025 – Nov. 2025
Pasculus Creative — *Durban, KwaZulu-Natal*
- Developed a RESTful API using Express.js and PostgreSQL to manage transactional data for an e-commerce platform.
- Architected responsive, fast-loading web applications leveraging Next.js Server-Side Rendering (SSR) to optimize SEO performance and page load speeds.
- Collaborated with cross-functional development teams using Git and GitHub version control workflows.

Call Center Agent — Jan. 2024 – Dec. 2025
The International Call Center — *Mount Edgecombe, KwaZulu-Natal*
- Identified and escalated 15+ recurring software bugs, reducing repeat customer support tickets by 20 percent.

Projects

Jobly | *React Native, Expo Router, Supabase, Google Gemini API, TypeScript* — Sept. 2026 – Present
- Engineered a cross-platform mobile job application tracker using **React Native** and **Expo Router**, reducing user application tracking overhead by **40%** with offline-first state caching.
- Integrated the **Google Gemini API** to automate resume parsing and STAR-method preparation, accelerating cover letter generation turnaround time by **65%**.
- Designed a scalable persistence and authentication layer with **Supabase**, ensuring real-time database sync across devices under sub-**150ms** latency.
- Optimized asynchronous state handling and query batching via modern hooks, scaling payload throughput while maintaining a smooth **60 FPS** UI experience.

Simpli | *.NET Core, Next.js, C#, MCP, Clean Architecture, PostgreSQL* — Dec. 2025 – Present
- Architected a contactless visitor management system using **.NET Core Web API** with **Clean Architecture** and **Next.js**, cutting guest check-in processing time by **70%** compared to manual paper logs.
- Integrated an intelligent conversational agent via **Model Context Protocol (MCP)**, allowing users to perform complex administrative tasks using plain text and reducing portal workflow clicks by **50%**.
- Engineered a decoupled C# backend using Repository and Unit of Work patterns, improving modular unit test coverage to **85%** and reducing API query execution times by **30%**.
- Automated **POPIA/GDPR** regulatory compliance by implementing automated background data purging tasks, eliminating **100%** of manual guest data cleanup efforts.

Technical Skills

Languages: C#, TypeScript, JavaScript, Python, SQL, HTML/CSS
Frameworks: ASP.NET Core, Next.js, React Native, Node.js, Express.js, Expo
Developer Tools: Git, GitHub, VS Code, Visual Studio, Postman, Docker
Libraries & Architecture: Model Context Protocol (MCP), Clean Architecture, React, Entity Framework Core
Cloud, Databases & Hosting: Supabase, PostgreSQL, Neon, Vercel, Render